1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

1 Making an emerging bowl is an exercise in making paper joints. Begin by cutting two blocks of wood 120 x 120 x 60mm and a square backing plate 120 x 120mm. In this instance both of the blocks are made of elm, but they don't have to be the same timber and, of course, they don't have to be elm. I used a piece of scrap MDF for the backing plate but any suitable material would do. Make sure the mating faces are smooth and clean. Glue the pieces together with a good quality PVA glue. Apply the glue to both wood faces and insert a sheet of paper between them. Cramp and leave overnight for the glue to set thoroughly

2 It is essential that the faceplate is mounted with its centre directly over the joint between the two elm blocks. Working from the joint lines, draw lines up the sides of the MDF and then join them across the top. Measure half way and mount the faceplate centred on this mark

3 Mount the faceplate securely on the backing plate. Use the longest screws you can but, obviously, they can't be too long or they will penetrate the elm blocks. As mine were shorter than I would normally use, I drilled extra holes in the faceplate to accommodate more screws

4 Mark a point half way down the glue joint and draw a line around the block. This shows the limits of the turned section

5 Mount the faceplate on the lathe and start to turn away the corners of the block on the lower section. Use a moderate speed so that the corners come round fairly quickly, and use a freshly sharpened 13mm bowl gouge. Avoid using a pointed centre in the tailstock to support the work because the wedge action of the centre may split the paper joint. If you feel additional support is necessary, use a ring centre instead

6 Gradually work back towards the pencil lines you drew round the block. It's not the end of the world if you go past them slightly but it may make the final bowl look a little unbalanced. Stop the lathe and look frequently as you develop a 'feel' for the cutting

7 The pencil line should be clearly visible on the square section as the lathe rotates the work. Using the bowl gouge, gradually cut in on the waste side of the line, removing wood from the corners of the block

8 Stop frequently to see whether you are keeping to the line. In this case I was drifting slightly. Correct the cut as you go, gradually increasing its depth until you are through the corners and into solid wood for the whole revolution

WT_291_51_55_ELM_BC_vsMBbcbdSD.indd 53 02/03/2016 09:44